

America or EU, and all of them, after winning the titles, became huge targets. Teams studied their playstyles closely and cracked the code that those teams seemed to be following which even they didn't know about. Sentinels were the first to fall from the throne, followed by Gambit and then Acend in the same manner. Not to mention the insane clutch game that 100 Thieves put up against them to win a game in which they were down 12-7 simply by avoiding the site cNed would be at. Acend failed to adapt to their weakness which was being too dependent on cNed's fragging potential and that's what cost them the Best of 3 that could've been rightfully theirs if only they took the right amount of time and patience to adapt.

NA becoming N/A : The teams from North America who had been making a big name for themselves slowly started to lose their touch. Players from Sentinels were called out for streaming almost as much as an actual streamer on Twitch and not practising enough.

Cloud9 had been a mess since the very beginning and got even worse after TenZ's departure, Version1 seemed to have lost their initial touch at the game and couldn't even qualify for the upcoming events and the case of TSM pains us to this day. A team with such great potential who had performed so well in the early days of Valorant seemed to have failed in keeping up to the constant changes in the game and was now only a name in history books.

The Rise of the New Generation :

The teams that had not been playing well at all started picking up steam in the next few months. Teams like The Guard picked up fresh fragging talent in the form of trent and started seeing wonders that fresh blood in the team seemed to be having. NRG got themselves a lineup as well with sOm being their wonderkid from GenG.

We also saw Paper Rex making a comeback and stronger than ever against the teams from the West. Not only Paper Rex though, Xerxia Esports from Thailand also made strides to



make a name for themselves as they qualified for Masters Reykjavik 2022.

More opportunity : Unlike last time, APAC got 2 slots in the Valorant Challengers series this time around making the presence of the South Asian region known to the world as even if one team would fail, the other would prevail and show the world what the region is capable of. Of course, out of the teams that participated, there wasn't a single Indian team. However, we did in fact put up a good fight. Velocity Gaming went a long way to make their place amongst the top 10 in the region currently holding the 7th place. Global eSports also did everything they could to get the best results possible in the tournament, going so far as to set up a temporary bootcamp in Singapore to



make sure their players get the best ping possible for the tournament.

Putting all these factors together, you start to see why Asia has been performing well in the Challengers series and will continue to do better in the future hopefully. As Korea and Japan continue to have an amazing track record in the game, we're also seeing teams from Thailand, Singapore, and of course, India making a name for themselves. Players like SkRossi(Global eSports),

f0rsaken(Paper Rex), and many more continue to pop off and produce clips that the world awes upon.

They carry the hopes of the region upon their shoulders and we can only hope that they find

more talented individuals such as themselves to share the burden with them to perform in a way that the entire region cheers them on.

CONCLUSION

The APAC region, though has come a long way, but still has a long way to go. We still lag behind other teams from other parts of the world such as the Brazilian Loud, or the Korean DRX. More importantly, the Indian teams need to do better if they ever wish to reach the level that their competitors are on and reach the international stage for the Valorant Champions



Tour and become not just famous in the region, but write history with their own hands by being the first Indian team to perform so very well on the International stage without the use of unfair means(*cough* forsaken *cough*). The reputation of Indian eSports took a huge hit when the incident in question happened making it is absolutely necessary for us to make a big splash on the global stage and this time in a good way. *